Intimate Partner Violence and Teen Sexual Health

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Statement of the Problem

- Approximately 50% of new HIV cases occur in persons younger than age 25. (CDC, 2001)
- Adolescents exposed to intimate partner violence (IPV) are less likely to use condoms. (Teitelman et al., 2008)
- Teens who experience IPV may be at greater risk of contracting HIV.
- This poster describes the development of a health communication to promote relationships free from intimate partner violence and to encourage condom use among adolescents. The health communication will be featured on an interactive website to promote healthy relationships (Principal Investigator: Sonya S. Brady, Ph.D.; Funding: University Grant-in-Aid and National Institute of Mental Health).

Methods

Literature Review

- Research articles were identified using the PsycINFO electronic database.
- Articles were reviewed and analyzed if they examined attitudes about IPV in society and the impact of IPV on sexual health among adolescents.
- Search terms included combinations of the following: (acceptance or tolerance) and (IPV or intimate partner violence) and (teens or adolescents).
- Reference lists of articles were used to identify other relevant sources. Additional sources were also provided by co-authors.
- Ten articles met review criteria.

Development of Health Communication

- The health communication was informed by my literature review and constructs of communication theory and the Information Motivation Behavioral Skills (IMB) Model of Health Behavior. (Fisher & Fisher, 2003)
- I focus on attention, understanding, and acceptance (communication theory constructs) and motivation (IMB Model construct).



Love isn't pain and fear…



Love is respect

Conceptual Model

Features to Attract Attention

- Health communication uses song lyrics by popular neo soul artist Raheem DeVaughn

Features to Promote Understanding

- Provides an explanation of why some teens tolerate IPV
- Discusses the link between IPV and sexual risk behavior
- Asserts that a healthy relationship is attainable

Objective 1: Acceptance

Teens will accept that…

- They deserve a relationship free from intimate partner violence
- Condom use can be part of a healthy relationship

Objective 2: Motivation

Teens will be motivated to…

- Have relationships free from IPV
- Use condoms if they have sex

Excerpts from Health Communication

"Love ain't pain, love ain't fear
Love ain't bruises, love ain't tears
Love ain't a two in the morning
phone call, phone call to 911
Love ain't fear for your life
day and night...
So tell me, tell me, what type of love is that to you?"

The threat of violence or abusive behaviors in a relationship that involves sex may increase a girl's feeling of powerlessness and fear.

Although music, movies and TV shows typically do not portray relationships without violence and cheating, they do exist.

Please never let anyone put their hands on you.
No one should "love" you until you are black and blue.

Using a condom does not have to mean that you do not trust your partner; it can mean that you love yourself and your partner enough to keep each other healthy.

"Love ain't designed to bring you down, Love don't beat you or mistreat you… Love is courage, love is hope
Love is facing all your fears
Love is strength in seeking help
Love is the joy inside your tears"

Key Findings from Literature Review

- 1 in 3 sexually active teen girls report ever experiencing physical or sexual violence from dating partners. (Decker et al., 2005)
- Adolescents know how to identify a healthy relationship and agree that intimate partner violence is unhealthy. Unfortunately, teens do not think that healthy relationships are attainable and as a result tolerate unhealthy behaviors from their partners. (Guzman et al., 2009)
- There is a strong association between attitudinal acceptance of dating violence and involvement with dating violence as a perpetrator or a victim. (Simon et al., 2010)
- The threat of violence in a sexual relationship may increase a woman's feeling of powerlessness and fear, limiting her ability to negotiate safer sex and increasing her likelihood of acquiring HIV and other STIs. (Buelna et al., 2009; Pulerwitz et al., 2002; Raiford et. al., 2009)

Recommendations

- Change social stigma around seeking help for experiences with IPV. School guidance counselors, teachers, the police, and trusted adults are appropriate options to help teens with IPV issues. (Black et al. 2008)
- Utilize peer educators to reduce IPV and HIV/AIDS. When teens do seek help for IPV, it is often from their fellow peers. (Black et al., 2008)
- Interventions aimed to reduce social isolation, build social skills, and provide youth with positive experiences with both male and female peers may be beneficial for reducing the likelihood of adolescents being perpetrators and victims of IPV. (Casey et al., 2010)

Potential Evaluation of Health Communication

* **What is true about intimate partner violence (IPV)? Please check all that apply.**

- ❑ Intimate Partner violence (IPV) includes physical or sexual violence and emotional abuse.
- ❑ Dating violence is ONLY directed towards women.
- ❑ Researchers have NOT found a link between relationship power and condom use.

* **After reading this article, which of the following statements do you agree with? Please check all that apply.**

- ❑ If two people use condoms they don't trust each other.
- ❑ I cannot think of any situation where it is okay for my partner to hit me.
- ❑ If I am annoying my partner it is okay for him or her to shove me.
- ❑ I will use condoms, if I have sex.

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Health Communication

Real Love Isn't Black and Blue

By Cherese Alcorn



~Black & Blue song lyrics by neo-soul artist Raheem Devaughn

Love ain't pain, love ain't fear
Love ain't bruises, love ain't tears
Love ain't a two in the morning phone call, phone call to 911
Love ain't fear for your life day and night
Isolated from your loved ones
And I know it ain't make up to cover your scars
Compromising who you are
So tell me, tell me, what type of love is that to you?

Have you or someone you know experienced dating violence? When two people are dating, one person might get angry and call the other person names, they might act jealous or possessive and try to keep that person from spending time with other friends or family, or they may even slap or punch the other person. In some situations, guys and girls are equally likely to be violent towards their partners in relationships. Even though these things can happen in relationships, it's never okay. Intimate partner violence (IPV) includes actual or threatened physical or sexual violence or mental and emotional abuse directed towards a current or former dating partner, girlfriend or boyfriend, or spouse.

Intimate partner violence affects all people across ages, cultures, and sexual orientation. Unfortunately, researchers have found that 1/3 of high school students have had experiences with unhealthy or abusive relationships. Violence in dating relationships does not only exist between men and women. Researchers have also found that almost 25% of teens in same sex relationships have reported experiencing dating violence.

Young people who have experienced dating violence have been found to carry abusive patterns into future relationships. To prevent this from happening, it is important to address dating violence as soon as you recognize it is happening.

If you are in a relationship and you are experiencing mental, physical, or verbal abuse from someone who says they love you, know that this is not love. If someone is trying to control what you do or who you talk to, threatening to hurt you, or pressuring you to have sex, those things are not love, and can be considered abusive.

Love ain't callin you out your name
Love ain't leavin you blue and black
Love is a man who has your back
Love won't knock you to the ground
Love ain't designed to bring you down
Love don't beat you or mistreat you
Or only loves you when he needs to

Dating violence can cause more than bruises and hurt feelings. Researchers have found a link between relationship violence and its effects on sexual health, especially when it comes to condom use. The threat of violence or abusive behaviors in a relationship that involves sex may increase a girl's feelings of powerlessness and fear. As a result, she may not be able to ask or insist to use condoms, which increases her likelihood of getting HIV and other sexually transmitted infections (STIs). Researchers have also found that guys who are controlling and abusive are more likely to use condoms in casual sexual relationships but not with steady partners. This means that steady partners are at risk for getting an STI.

In same sex relationships, sometimes people assume that because partners are the same gender, they can't experience dating violence. This isn't true. In any relationship, if one person tries to control or manipulate another person, it can be considered abusive.

Love is courage, love is hope
Love is facing all your fears
Love is strength in seeking help
Love is the joy inside your tears
Love is help to lend a hand

It is okay to want a relationship free of mental, verbal, and physical violence. True love should never be mentally, verbally, and or physically hurtful. It is okay to talk to friends and adults you trust to ask questions about unhealthy or abusive relationships.

It is okay to have high standards and expectations for romantic relationships. When asked, many teens say they want relationships that include trust, respect, and commitment. Teens also want relationships that do not include cheating. Most young people can identify the qualities of healthy sexual and romantic relationships but many teens think they cant find those things in their own relationships. Although music, movies and TV shows typically do not portray relationships without violence and cheating, they do exist.

It is okay to be in charge of your sexual health and romantic relationships. You are more important than anyone else. Teens who feel like they have relationships where they can make decisions and say what they think are more likely to report consistent condom use. Using a condom does not have to mean that you do not trust your partner; it can mean that you love yourself and your partner enough to keep each other healthy. It is okay to want to use birth control and a condom as a back-up to protect against STIs and prevent a pregnancy before you are ready.

Love is this from me to you--Only to love you, only to kiss you, only to hug you

Please never let anyone put their hand on you. No one should "love" you until you are black and blue.